Seeing while passing

Syngraphe / IG II² 1668, selected clauses from lines 12–14 and 85–91. New English and diagrams: Anthony Mercer, 2026. Printed evidence: Auguste Choisy, 1884.

> Modern two-dimensional sightline study: one isolated support, two illustrative chests and one sample point per chest. Selected opening faces are held open for this test; the ancient clause concerns which faces can be opened. Seeing the samples does not establish visibility of all equipment or reconstruct the building.

Wall chest: Front only. Pillar chest: Both sides. Viewer at 20 feet relative to the isolated support.

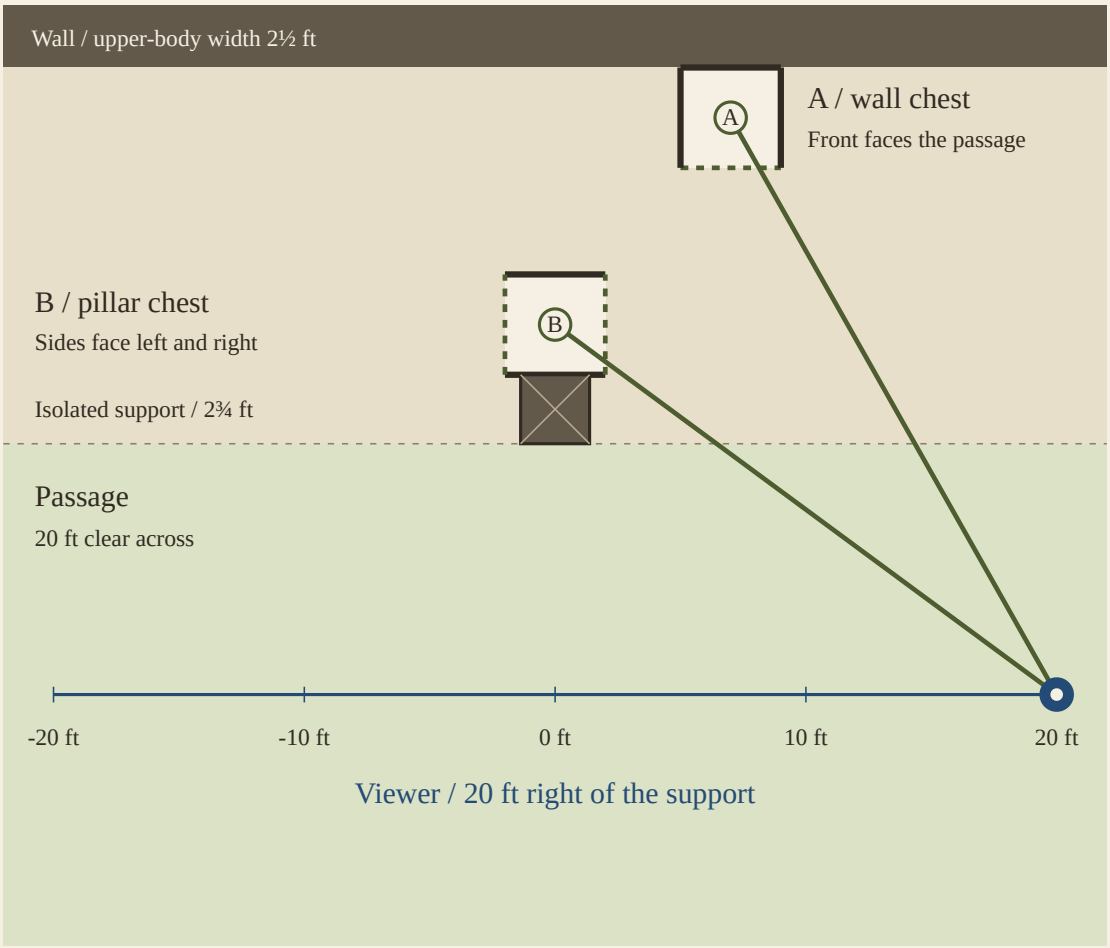
Stated opening faces: wall chest agrees; pillar chest agrees. This comparison concerns the selected faces only, not all the building's requirements.

A: Sample point visible through an open face. B: Sample point visible through an open face.

Save editable JSON · Save all stations as CSV · Save current SVG

Your selected position: 20 ft

Local study from above / chest sizes and positions chosen



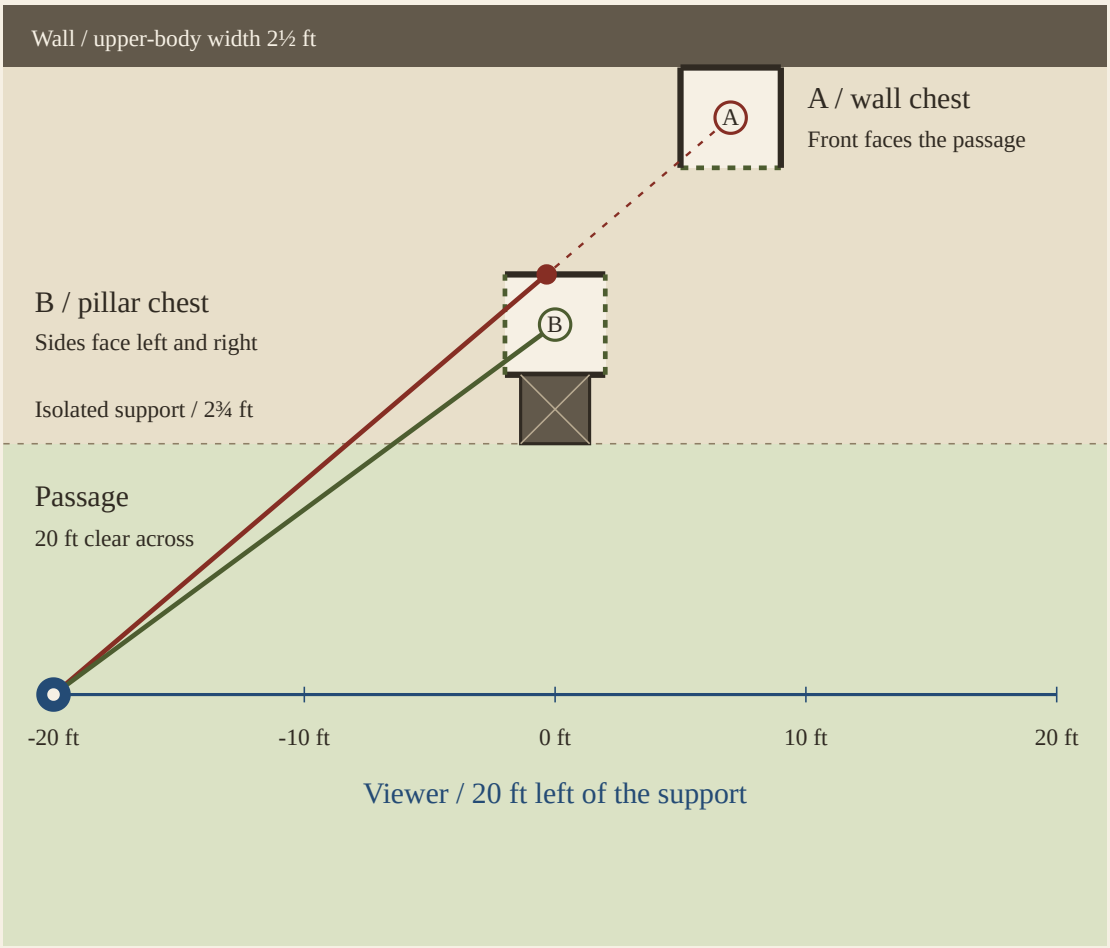
Solid ray: visible path or first obstruction. Dots: blocked continuation.

Two sample points are not all the equipment. No height or lighting is modelled.

A: Sample point visible through an open face. B: Sample point visible through an open face.

Another position: -20 ft

Local study from above / chest sizes and positions chosen



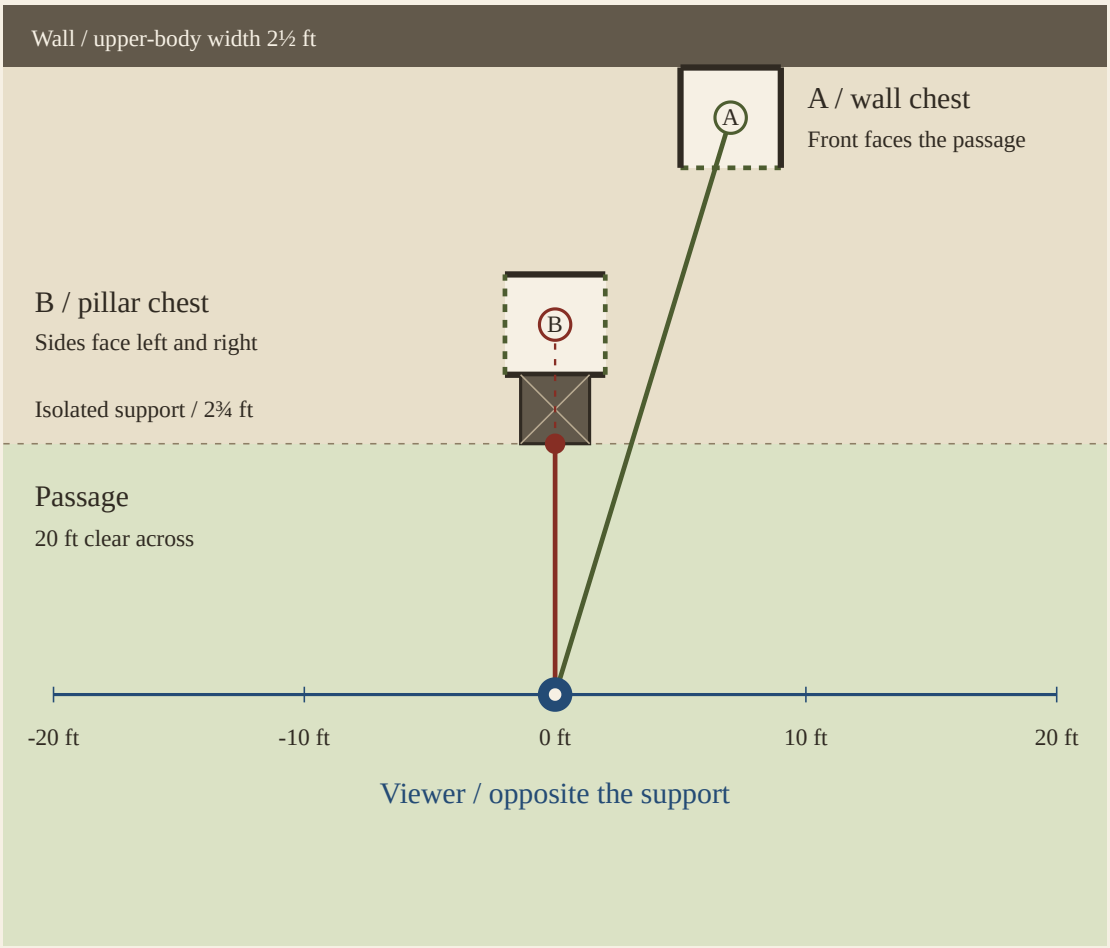
Solid ray: visible path or first obstruction. Dots: blocked continuation.

Two sample points are not all the equipment. No height or lighting is modelled.

A: Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's back face. B: Sample point visible through an open face.

Another position: 0 ft

Local study from above / chest sizes and positions chosen



Solid ray: visible path or first obstruction. Dots: blocked continuation.

Two sample points are not all the equipment. No height or lighting is modelled.

A: Sample point visible through an open face. B: Sightline stopped by the support.

All 41 stations

These are independent observations at one-foot intervals from −20 to +20 feet. No cumulative visit history is asserted. A visible sample is not a visible whole chest.

Station (ft)	A / wall sample	B / pillar sample
-20	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's back face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
-19	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's back face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
-18	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's back face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
-17	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's back face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
-16	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's back face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
-15	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's back face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
-14	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's back face.	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.
-13	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.
-12	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.
-11	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.
-10	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-9	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-8	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-7	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-6	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-5	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-4	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-3	Sightline stopped by the support.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-2	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
-1	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
0	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
1	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
2	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.

Station (ft)	A / wall sample	B / pillar sample
3	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
4	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
5	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
6	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
7	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
8	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
9	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
10	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the support.
11	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.
12	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.
13	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.
14	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sightline stopped by the pillar chest's front face.
15	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
16	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
17	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
18	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
19	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sample point visible through an open face.
20	Sample point visible through an open face.	Sample point visible through an open face.

IG II² 1668, lines 12–14

A passage for the people

διαλείπων δ[ί]οδον τῶι δήμωι διὰ μέσ[η]ς τῆς σκευοθήκης. πλάτος τὸ μεταξὺ τῶν κιόνων εἴκοσι ποδῶν,

Leaving a passage for the people through the middle of the storehouse. Width between the pillars: twenty feet.

The beneficiary is the people, not a named official. The later chest clause states a purpose of seeing while passing. Neither clause describes an inspection ritual, proves actual public use, or specifies our viewer's position.

τῶι δήμωι
for the people. Dictionary form: δῆμος. A dative names the passage's beneficiary.

μεταξὺ τῶν κιόνων
between the pillars. Dictionary form: μεταξύ. Twenty feet is clear between the support rows in this width account.

σκευοθήκης
of the equipment storehouse. Dictionary form: σκευοθήκη. A place for gear. "Arsenal" here refers to naval stores, rather than a modern weapons factory.

Whole printed evidence: PDF p.34.

IG II² 1668, lines 85–87

Chests made to a pattern

ποιήσει δὲ καὶ κιβωτοὺς τοῖς ἱστίοις καὶ τοῖς παραρρύμασιν τοῖς λευκοῖς, ἀριθμὸν ἑκατὸν τριάκοντα τέτταρας, πρὸς τὸ παράδειγμα ποιήσας,

Make chests too, for the sails and the white side-hangings, one hundred and thirty-four in number, making them according to the pattern.

The pattern (παράδειγμα) is mentioned, but no chest width or depth is supplied in this excerpt. Our two four-foot squares are illustrative. We do not derive a complete arrangement of the 134 chests, identify their contents point by point, or treat naval equipment as modern ammunition.

κιβωτοὺς
chests / boxes. Dictionary form: κιβωτός. Containers whose faces can be opened in the next clause.

τοῖς ἱστίοις
for the sails. Dictionary form: ἱστίον. Names one kind of naval equipment to be stored.

πρὸς τὸ παράδειγμα
according to the pattern / model. Dictionary form: παράδειγμα. The written excerpt points beyond itself to a supplied pattern. Our square chest is not that ancient pattern.

Whole printed evidence: PDF p.40.

IG II² 1668, lines 88–89

By the wall: the front

καὶ ποιήσει ἀνοιγνυμένας, τῶμ μὲν πρὸς τῶι τοίχωι κειμένων τὸμ πρόσθιον τοῖχον,

And make them so that they open: for those lying by the wall, [through] the front wall.

The supplied English preposition in brackets makes the abbreviated construction readable. This specifies which faces can open; our test holds those selected faces open. The printed τῶμ and τὸμ are retained; they are assimilated forms, not misspelled menu labels. 'Front' in the drawing means the chest face toward the passage. No hinge or door swing is reconstructed.

ἀνοιγνυμένας
opening / being opened. Dictionary form: ἀνοίγνυμι. The sides can be opened; this does not say that every panel stood permanently open.

πρὸς τῶι τοίχωι
by the wall. Dictionary form: πρός + dative; τοῖχος. Selects the wall-side chests, not every chest in the building.

τὸμ πρόσθιον τοῖχον
the front wall / face. Dictionary form: πρόσθιος; τοῖχος. Open the face toward the passage for this group.

Whole printed evidence: PDF p.41.

IG II² 1668, lines 89–91

By the pillars: both sides

τῶν δὲ κατὰ τοὺς κίονας κειμένων ἀμφοτέρους τοὺς πλαγίους τοίχους,

But for those lying by the pillars, [through] both side walls.

The μὲν … δὲ contrast divides two groups of chests. Both side walls is stronger than either one side or a generic 'open chest'. The following sightline experiment does not prove that this was the only geometry able to reveal any contents.

κατὰ τοὺς κίονας
by / in line with the pillars. Dictionary form: κατά; κίων. Selects the second chest group. Its exact offset and size are chosen in our diagram.

ἀμφοτέρους
both of the two. Dictionary form: ἀμφότερος. Providing only one openable side falls short of the stated two-side requirement. Closing an openable panel temporarily is a different question.

τοὺς πλαγίους τοίχους
the side walls / faces. Dictionary form: πλάγιος; τοῖχος. These are different faces from the front named for the wall chests.

Whole printed evidence: PDF p.41.

IG II² 1668, lines 91

So people passing through can see

ὅπως ἂν ᾖι ὁρᾶν ἅπαντα τὰ σκεύη διεξιοῦσιν,

So that those passing through can see all the equipment.

This is the purpose clause, ending at Choisy's comma; the following wording is not silently merged with the different modern IG reading. 'Passing through' motivates moving the viewer, but our 41 positions and two sample points are modern choices. Seeing those points is a much weaker test than seeing all the equipment.

ὁρᾶν
to see. Dictionary form: ὁράω. The stated purpose concerns visibility. It does not give the optical assumptions of this model.

ἅπαντα τὰ σκεύη
all the equipment. Dictionary form: ἅπας; σκεῦος. Two visible sample points cannot establish this universal claim.

διεξιοῦσιν
for those passing through. Dictionary form: διεξέρχομαι. The people move through; they are not required here to stand on our centre mark.

Whole printed evidence: PDF p.41.

What the diagram chooses

The earlier room's schematic account combines a 2½-foot upper wall body, a 2¾-foot support base, fifteen feet including that support and a twenty-foot passage. The support has a square footprint here; the source's breadth does not prescribe that shape.

The wall chest occupies x = 5…9 and y = 31…35 feet; the pillar chest x = −2…2 and y = 22¾…26¾. Their centre samples are (7,33) and (0,24¾). The support occupies x = −1⅜…1⅜ and y = 20…22¾. The viewer moves at y = 10. The coordinates, four-foot chest sizes and isolated-support setup are modern choices. Front is toward the passage (lower y); left/right are the long direction (lower/higher x).

Closed faces are opaque zero-thickness lines; open faces are removed, without simulating a hinged panel. Straight two-dimensional segments stop at the first closed face or support, including corner contact. Neighbouring supports, grilles, doors, vertical obstructions, stored objects, illumination and people are omitted.

Front openings on both chests can expose both samples somewhere along this path while failing the pillar wording. Conversely, the stated openings can leave a sample hidden at a particular station. Neither result refutes the inscription: these samples and this geometry are ours. No reconstruction of all 134 chests, inspection procedure or actual historical use is asserted. The translations and word notes have not received independent philological review.

ÉTUDES ÉPIGRAPHIQUES

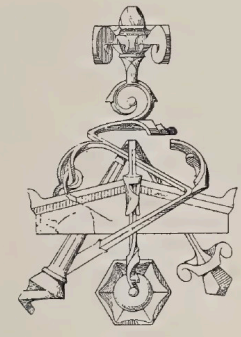
SUR

L'ARCHITECTURE GRECQUE

PAR

AUGUSTE CHOISY

INGÉNIEUR EN CHEF DES PONTS ET CHAUSSÉES



PARIS

LIBRAIRIE DE LA SOCIÉTÉ ANONYME DE PUBLICATIONS PÉRIODIQUES

13-15, QUAI VOLTAIRE, 13-15

M DCCC LXXXIV

Title, 1884 / PDF p.15. Choisy, Études épigraphiques sur l'architecture grecque, 1884. Getty Research Institute copy digitized by Internet Archive. Whole margins, Greek, French and notes retained.

Ayant creusé l'emplacement sur une épaisseur de trois pieds à partir du point le plus haut et ayant régularisé le surplus : sur l'aire on posera les assises d'un massif et on les élèvera [les arasant] en tête à hauteur uniforme : le tout dressé au niveau.

On prolongera les assises [du massif] jusque sous les piliers, en réservant à partir de chaque mur un espace [qui est] de quinze pieds y compris l'épaisseur du pilier[1].

Nombre des piliers de chaque file : trente-cinq, les deux files laissant entre elles au milieu de l'arsenal un passage public.

Dans l'intervalle entre les [deux files de] piliers, [intervalle qui sera de] vingt pieds, on élèvera le massif [jusqu'à] la hauteur de quatre pieds, posant les pierres alternativement en manière de clayonnage[2] et dans le sens de la longueur.

On construira les murs de l'arsenal ainsi que les piliers en pierre d'Acté, donnant aux murs un socle (A). Largeur des pierres [de ce socle] : trois pieds; épaisseur, trois demi-pieds: longueur, quatre

οδῶν καὶ πέντε σὺν τοῖς τοίχοις. Κατατεμὼν τοῦ χωρίου βάθος ἀπὸ τοῦ μετεωροτάτου τρεῖς πόδας, τὸ ἄλλο ἀνακαθαράμενος, ἐπὶ τὸ στέριφον στρωματιεῖ καὶ ἀναλήψεται ἴσον κατὰ κεφαλήν· ἅπαν ὀρθὸν πρὸς τὸν διαβήτην. Στρωματιεῖ δὲ καὶ τοῖς κίοσιν ἀπολείπων ἀπὸ τοῦ τοίχου ἑκατέρου πέντε κ[αὶ δέκα] πόδας σὺν τῶι πάχει τοῦ κίονος. Ἀριθμὸς τῶν κιόνων ἑκατέρου τοῦ στοίχου πέντε καὶ τριάκοντα, διαλείπων δ[ι]οδον τῶι δήμωι διὰ μέσ[η]ς τῆς σκευοθήκης. Πλάτος τὸ μεταξὺ τῶν κιόνων εἴκοσι ποδῶν, πάχος ἐπιθήσει τὸ στρῶμα τετράπουν, τιθεὶς τοὺς λίθους ἐναλλὰξ [φ]ορ[μηδ]ὸν καὶ παρὰ μῆκος. Οἰκοδομήσει δὲ τοὺς τοίχους τῆς σκευοθήκης καὶ [τ]οὺς κίονας ἀκτίτου λίθου, θεὶς εὐθυντηρί-

aux personnages qui donnent leur nom à l'arsenal, M. Foucart, se fondant sur une analogie empruntée à l'inscription des murs d'Athènes, pense que ces personnages sont l'un des épistates de la construction et l'architecte.

[1] C. à d. on interrompra le remblai dans l'intervalle compris entre chacun des murs et la file de colonnes : intervalle qu'il faudra plus tard recouvrir d'un plancher (l. 66).

Cf. Thucyd. II, 75.

Printed p.6 · inclusive widths and public passage / PDF p.34. Choisy, Études épigraphiques sur l'architecture grecque, 1884. Getty Research Institute copy digitized by Internet Archive. Whole margins, Greek, French and notes retained.

le long de chacun des deux murs, et doubles en hauteur. Et on les coudera le long des murs en retour et suivant [l'alignement des] colonnes : on les coudera de chaque côté [de l'édifice]. Et on fera la tablette inférieure (K′) à une hauteur de quatre pieds à partir du plancher, et la tablette supérieure (K″) distante de l'autre de cinq pieds.

Ayant dressé, depuis le plancher inférieur jusqu'au plancher supérieur, un montant (*v*) de un demi-pied, épais de six doigts [et] ayant fixé contre les montants des traverses (*s′* et *s″*) de même épaisseur [qu'eux], on posera sur ces [traverses] des tasseaux continus (*x* et *z*), un de chaque coté, épais de six doigts dans chaque sens ; et sur ces [tasseaux] on posera après les avoir rendues jointives, des planches longues de quatre pieds, larges de trois pieds, épaisses de deux doigts, et on les clouera s'assemblant et affleurant avec les tasseaux.

Et on fera des échelles de bois pour monter sur les tablettes.

Et on fera aussi des coffres pour les voiles et les garnitures blanches[1] : [on les fera] au nombre de cent trente-quatre, d'après

ει παρὰ τοὺς πλ[α]γίους τοίχους καὶ κατὰ τοὺς κίονας· ἐπικάμψει καθ' ἑκάστην τὴν χώραν. Ὕψος δὲ ποιήσει ἀπὸ τῆς ὀροφῆς τεττάρων ποδῶν, τὴν δὲ ἐπάνω μεσόμνην ἀπὸ τῆς ἑτέρας ἀπέχουσαν πέντε πόδας. Ἰκριωτῆρα στήσας ἀπὸ τῆς κάτω ὀροφῆς μέχρι τῆς ἄνω ὀροφῆς, πλάτος ἡμιποδίου, πάχος ἓξ δακτύλων, διερείσας διερείσματα εἰς τοὺς ἰκριωτῆρας τὸ αὐτὸ πάχος, θράνους ἐπιθήσει διανεκεῖς, ἕνα ἑκατέρωθεν, πάχος ἓξ δακτύλων πανταχῇ· καὶ ἐπὶ τούτων ἐπιθήσει πίνακας συνκολλήσας, μῆκος τετράποδας, πλάτος τρίποδας, πάχος δυοῖν δακτύλοιν καὶ [κ]αθηλώσει συναρμόττοντας ἐξ ἴσου τοῖς θράνοις. Καὶ κλίμακας ποιήσει ξυλίνας ἀναβαίνειν ἐπὶ τὰς μεσόμνας. Ποιήσει δὲ καὶ κιβωτοὺς τοῖς ἱστίοις καὶ τοῖς παραρρύμασιν τοῖς λευκοῖς ἀριθμὸν ἑκατὸν τριάκοντα τέτταρας, πρὸς τὸ παράδειγμα ποιήσας, καὶ θήσει κατὰ τὸ-

[1] D'après M. Cartaud (*la Trière athén.*), cet agrès serait une tenture d'étoffe peu combustible servant à protéger le navire contre l'incendie.

Printed p.12 · chests, sails and the supplied pattern / PDF p.40. Choisy, Études épigraphiques sur l'architecture grecque, 1884. Getty Research Institute copy digitized by Internet Archive. Whole margins, Greek, French and notes retained.

le modèle [qui sera fourni] ; et on les placera un en face de chaque pilier, et un dans l'espace intermédiaire. Et les fera s'ouvrant : ceux posés le long des murs, par leur face antérieure ; et au contraire, ceux posés en face des piliers, par l'une et l'autre de leurs faces latérales, afin de permettre aux promeneurs de voir en quel état se trouvent tous les objets [contenus] dans l'arsenal.

Et, afin qu'il y ait de la fraîcheur dans l'arsenal, lorqu'on bâtira l'arsenal on laissera des interstices entre les pierres si l'architecte l'ordonne.

Le tout, les entrepreneurs l'exécuteront selon les [présentes] conventions, et selon les mesures et selon le modèle qu'expliquera l'architecte, et ils livreront chacun des ouvrages dans les délais souscrits par eux.

ν κίονα ἕκαστον καὶ μίαν εἰς τὸ καταντ[ικρὺ] χωρίον. Καὶ ποιήσει ἀνοιγνυμένας τῶμ μὲν πρὸς τῶι τοίχωι κειμένων τὸμ πρόσθιον τοῖχον, τῶν δὲ κατὰ τοὺς κίονας κειμένων ἀμφοτέρους τοὺς πλαγίους τοίχους, ὅπως ἂν ᾖι ὁρᾶν ἅπαντα τὰ σκεύη διεξιοῦσιν, ὅπως ἂν ᾖι ἐν τῆι σκευοθήκηι. Ὅπως δ' ἂν καὶ ψῦχος ᾖι ἐν τῆι σκευοθήκηι, , ὅταν οἰκοδομῆι τοὺς τοίχους τῆς σκευοθήκης, διαλείψει τῶν πλινθίδων ἐν τοῖς ἁρμοῖς ᾗι ἂν κελεύηι ὁ ἀρχιτέκτων. Ταῦτα ἅπαντα ἐξεργάσονται οἱ μισθωσάμενοι κατὰ τὰς συγγραφὰς καὶ πρὸς τὰ μέτρα καὶ πρὸς τὸ παράδειγμα, ὃ ἂν φράζηι ὁ ἀρχιτέκτων, καὶ ἐν τοῖς χρόνοις ἀποδώσουσιν, οἷς ἂν μισθώσουνται ἕκαστα τῶν ἔργων.

Printed p.13 · opening faces and seeing while passing / PDF p.41. Choisy, Études épigraphiques sur l'architecture grecque, 1884. Getty Research Institute copy digitized by Internet Archive. Whole margins, Greek, French and notes retained.

Sources and rights

Source PDF SHA-256: 418e65e07dbdec0e0e2adc5d8dbbb47ec8d9e00f46bb6d52c0e5eed4d7991d15. All four page images and the local font are embedded and were checked against this edition's byte lengths and SHA-256 values before saving. This reading uses no scripts or remote image/font requests. Its native JSON, CSV and SVG downloads work without scripts.

Choisy's 1884 volume / Modern IG transcript for comparison. Initial case and excerpt punctuation are normalized; the retained printed spellings, restorations and excerpt boundaries are disclosed in the notes.

Historical publication: public domain in the United States; Choisy died in 1909. New code, English and diagrams: MIT, Copyright (c) 2026 Anthony Mercer. Font: Noto Serif, SIL OFL 1.1.

▶ Complete font license
▶ Complete MIT license